



• CONFIDENTIAL — INTERNAL STRATEGY

— SWITCHING ONBOARDING BLUEPRINT

Stop building a funnel. Build a switch-readiness engine.

A CX-optimised, regulation-safe onboarding flow for Bondly's home-loan switching service — benchmarked against every SA originator, the SA banks' own switch journeys, and the world's best remortgage fintechs, then adversarially stress-tested.

♦ THE VERDICT, IN ONE BREATH

Keep the spine — sharpen the edges, and change one belief. Bondly's savings-first, no-hard-credit-check, progressive-ladder flow already matches the global best-practice switching pattern (Athena, Habito, Mojo) and is the strongest onboarding opening in the SA market. Don't rebuild it. Win by reframing the product: Bondly is not a switch funnel — it is a **switch-readiness engine** that converts the minority who should switch *today* and compounds a rate-watch list of the majority who will switch *tomorrow*.

The edge: own the switch before MortgageMarket does — honestly.

No South African player leads with a **savings-first, multi-bank, no-hard-credit-check switching** journey for existing homeowners. The originators are purchase-led (BetterBond explicitly won't do simple rate-switching); the banks' switch pages are single-lender and form-first. That gap is real, and Bondly is already standing in it. But it is a **6–12 month window, not a moat** — so the recommendation is to move fast on five sharpening moves and one reframe, while building the one asset that compounds: the nurture list.

The five things that decide this

- **Biggest opportunity** — a multi-bank, savings-first *switch* funnel is uncontested in SA. Bondly can own "*switch, let banks compete, we handle everything.*"
- **Biggest threat** — MortgageMarket just won direct origination contracts with all banks (May/Jun '26) + 2-min Experian pre-qual. The window is now.
- **The honesty fix that is also the growth lever** — show *net* savings after switching costs + break-even months on the Verdict. It's a CPA s.41 duty *and* it sorts visitors into "switch now" vs "watch."
- **Kill fear-of-rejection** — reframe the Switch Score as *bankability*, earned by a soft non-pull signal (LTV + affordability band), not an empty promise.
- **Get one number first** — the bank→originator commission on a *switch* (+ clawback on early cancellation). It decides how hard to push funnel vs nurture.

DO Ship first

- Net-of-cost Verdict (break-even + loss-framing + "your new bank may cover R10k–R30k").
- Compliant rate-watch opt-in (POPIA s.69) keyed to prime moves + LTV milestones.
- "What Bondly does for you" admin-disappears checklist.

DON'T Ship yet

- The "3+ banks will compete" claim with *zero* credit signal — CPA s.41 exposure.
- SA ID capture before formal-application intent — POPIA data-minimisation.
- Treating the funnel as the whole product — the median bond can't switch profitably today.

"Most of your visitors shouldn't switch this year — and that is the business, not the problem."

The break-even math (R30k–R40k friction vs ~R300/mo saved on a small rate gap) means the volume play is "watch & switch later." Build the list; convert the qualified minority now. Full reasoning on p.8.

THE ONE BIG CALL

Reframe Bondly as a switch-readiness engine. The Verdict screen becomes a sorting machine: it qualifies and converts the high-value "switch-now" segment (large bonds, big rate gaps, low LTV — where a new bank covers most costs), and it captures everyone else into a compounding, compliant rate-watch list that re-engages on prime cuts and equity milestones. That single change turns your structural weakness (thin switch-now inventory) into your durable moat (a proprietary, intent-rich audience no competitor can copy by cloning your funnel).

Three reframes, then a ranked build order.

R1

Product = engine, not funnel

Median sub- $\text{\$1.5m}$ bond: $\sim\text{\$30-40k}$ friction $\div \sim\text{\$300/mo}$ saving on a 0.5% cut = **8-10yr break-even**. So "switch now" is the *value* business (big bonds, $\geq 1\%$ gaps, low LTV); "watch & switch later" is the *volume* business. The rate-watch list is co-equal, not a footnote.

R2

Earn the bankability claim

You can't honestly say "3+ banks will compete" with no data — that's a CPA s.41 misleading-representation risk. Keep "no *hard* credit check," but compute a **soft non-pull signal** (LTV from balance $\div$ est. value, affordability band, arrears self-declaration) and calibrate the claim to it.

R3

It's a window, not a wall

Funnel mechanics are replicable — MortgageMarket could bolt a switch flow onto direct bank contracts in a quarter, *with* a credit signal. Bondly's durable edge is switch-specific positioning + CX craft + the compounding nurture asset + "we make the admin disappear."

How to win — ranked by impact $\times$ effort

★ = AI-ENABLED

#	MOVE	IMPACT	EFFORT	THE COMPETITOR WEAKNESS IT EXPLOITS
1	Net-of-cost Verdict — break-even months + loss-framing + bank cost-coverage	Very high	Low	Every SA player hides switching costs in the early funnel; honesty here is both a CPA duty and the trust differentiator.
2	Compliant rate-watch nurture ★ — prime-move + LTV-milestone triggers	Very high	Low-Med	No SA player owns the "not yet — we'll tell you when" relationship. Captures the 60%+ who shouldn't switch today.
3	"What Bondly does for you" admin-disappears checklist + bridging-finance flag	High	Low	Inertia is the #1 killer. Capitec's "Quick Cash" bridge is the only SA answer; no originator names the admin it absorbs.
4	Bankability Switch Score (soft non-pull signal) + calibrated "banks compete" framing	High	Med	Fear-of-rejection silently kills qualified leads; competitors bury eligibility behind a hard check or a wall.
5	Tighten the data ladder — email-only at peak intent; ID late; phone optional; non-zero progress; save & resume	High	Med	ooba/MortgageMarket/EasyMortgages gate behind a full registration wall <i>before</i> any value.
6	Cash-out / equity-release third Verdict framing (conditional on LTV)	Med	Low	SA Home Loans surfaces it; originators bury it. A distinct, high-intent switcher segment.
7	Persona branching — fixed-rate, high-LTV, recent-bond, self-employed get honest expectations, not a rosy Verdict	Med	Med	Every calculator-led flow sets false expectations the back-end must walk back, burning trust + consultant time.
8	Plain-English consent + named-banks sharing screen ★	Med	Low	Standard Bank is the only player with legible consent; all others bury it. Transparency is a cheap trust win.
0	Pre-build: confirm switch unit-economics — bank→originator commission % on a switch + clawback terms	Gating	Low	Decides whether to push the funnel hard or lead with the nurture list. The one number not publicly knowable.

Moves 1-3 are the "ship first" wave (low effort, highest leverage, all compliance-positive). Move 0 is a phone call to your bank partners, not a build — but it sets the strategy.

The flow, screen by screen.

Bondly's current ladder is the right architecture. Below is the sharpened version — what to **keep**, what's **new**, and what to **fix**. Ordering is justified by the behavioural evidence on p.7.

KEEP — already best-in-market NEW — net-add FIX — change vs current

0

Hero calculator KEEP MOAT

Outstanding balance + current rate (term & bank optional), **or** "upload your bond statement, we'll read it." Sub-3 fields, framed as a tool not a form. This is the strongest opening in the SA market — **defend it**; A/B-test any new pre-result field before adding it. Trust strip: **"No credit check · Free · POPIA-protected,"** with the 7 bank logos.

1

"Reading your details" animation KEEP

Primes the result as computed-and-personal, not generic — measurably lifts perceived credibility of the number that follows. Keep it short.

2

The Verdict UPGRADE — the single highest-leverage screen

Keep: savings range (not false precision); the "lower monthly vs finish sooner" toggle.

Add — loss framing: "At your rate you're paying ~R1,850 more every month than you need to — about R22,200 over the next year." Losses motivate ~2× gains.

Add — net-of-cost reality: "Switching costs ≈ R18k-R25k; at your saving you break even in ~13 months — and your new bank may cover R10k-R30k of it." This is the trust differentiator and a CPA s.41 obligation.

Add — bankability Switch Score: reframe X/100 from "how much you save" to "how likely banks compete for you," computed from a **soft non-pull** signal (LTV + affordability band). One-line basis + non-advice disclaimer.

Add (conditional): cash-out/equity line if LTV < ~75%. **Add:** "What Bondly does for you" checklist (appoint attorneys · handle cancellation + 90-day notice · chase the banks · coordinate registration).

CTA: "Get my bank offers →". Competitive-rate branch → the rate-watch opt-in (step 9).

3

Capture contact — email only FIX

"Where should we send your bank offers?" Email is the lowest-anxiety ask and intent peaks right after the Verdict. **Remove the phone field here** — phone early is a documented conversion leak (~70% are reluctant; making it optional has doubled completion in case studies). POPIA s.18 just-in-time notice sits beneath the field. **Start the progress indicator non-zero ("Step 1 of 4 complete")** — the calculator was already real effort (endowed-progress effect).

4

Light qualify — income band + employment KEEP

Bands (not exact rands) + employment type, on one screen, in plain language. Feeds the soft bankability signal. This is already well-judged; keep it. Show bank logos again — trust anxiety peaks here.

...then commit, submit, and sort.

- 5

Formal details — *split across screens*

FIX

Never cluster name + ID + income + address on one screen (the single biggest avoidable abandonment risk). Sequence: **(5a)** full name + optional phone → **(5b)** SA ID on its own screen, gated behind a clear "Yes, submit my application to banks" intent, with lock icon, **"why we need this,"** POPIA note + "no credit check" copy → **(5c)** property address (autocomplete). Collecting the ID this late satisfies POPIA data-minimisation and de-risks the highest-anxiety field.
- 6

Statement upload — optional accelerator, at the end

FIX

"Upload your latest bond statement for a firmer offer (optional — you can do this later)." SA has no mature open banking, so the statement is the only real self-serve income signal — but it belongs **after** commitment, framed as a bonus, never a gate. Capture the lead first; enrich asynchronously. (Tension noted on p.7: if bank-acceptance rates suffer, move a **soft** signal earlier — not the full doc.)
- 7

Named-banks consent + confirm

NEW

"Your application will be submitted to: ABSA · FNB · Nedbank ... [Confirm & submit]." Naming the recipients is both POPIA best practice (purpose-specific sharing consent) and good UX — and it makes the "banks compete for you" promise concrete. Heads-up here: the 90-day notice to your current bank, and the cost picture.
- 8

Confirmation + pipeline tracker

KEEP

Keep the "You're in" success screen, the 6-step pipeline, and the create-account-to-track CTA. Add a clear timeline expectation and a post-switch nurture hook (6-month balance check-in → "shall we re-check your rate?").
- 9

Rate-watch — the parallel exit for "not yet"

NEW · THE VOLUME PLAY

Anyone the Verdict sorts as "not worth it yet" gets a **standalone, un-pre-ticked, Form-4-compliant** POPIA s.69 opt-in: **"We'll tell you the moment switching pays — when prime moves or your equity crosses a threshold."** Triggers are prime-rate cuts + LTV milestones (SA bonds are prime-linked, so there is no UK-style fixed-term expiry to wait for). This is the compounding asset.

Honest persona branching — who the calculator must *not* over-promise

PERSONA	WHY A ROSY VERDICT MISLEADS	WHAT THE FLOW SHOULD DO
High-LTV / low-equity	Banks won't compete; switching costs sink the math.	Route to "improve your profile" + rate-watch, not "apply now."
Recently originated (<2–3 yrs)	Costs not yet amortised; some bonds carry an early-cancellation penalty.	Show a longer break-even honestly; usually → rate-watch.
Self-employed / thin-file	Income band ≠ bankable; banks need 6–12 months of statements.	Flag the docs needed; set a human-assisted expectation early.
On a fixed rate	Break penalties make a mid-fix switch punitive (a small minority — fixed is capped at 60 months and uncommon).	Detect & warn; offer rate-watch for when the fix ends.
Access-bond / readvance	Switching can forfeit a flexible facility they value.	Surface the trade-off; let a consultant weigh it.

Everyone sells the purchase. Nobody owns the switch.

SA splits into purchase-led **originators** (paid by the bank, credit-checked up front), single-lender **bank switch pages**, and the one genuine switching specialist (**SA Home Loans / Capitec**) — which is single-lender and callback-led. The savings-first, multi-bank, no-hard-check switch lane is empty.

PLAYER	FIRST ASK	CREDIT CHECK	DEDICATED SWITCH?	THE OPENING IT LEAVES BONDLY
ooba #1 originator	Registration wall (name→OTP→ID)	Auto pull after sign-up	No — refinance = same new-bond flow	Value is gated behind a wall; switching isn't a product.
BetterBond	Anonymous affordability calc	At pre-qualification	No — explicitly excludes "simple rate negotiations"	The #2 originator won't even serve pure switchers.
MortgageMarket ▲ threat	Account-first (ID+email+cell)	Soft Experian, <2 min	No (purchase framing) — but now has direct bank contracts	Closest mover; could add a switch flow fast, with a credit signal.
EasyMortgages (EasyEquities)	Profile creation	Soft check	No — purchase, 7-bank, R5k cashback	Brand halo, but no switch wedge.
SA Home Loans / Capitec	"Do you bank with us?" segmenter	Step 4, post-docs	Yes — deepest in market (switch calc, Quick Cash bridge, 10-step)	Strong but <i>single-lender</i> + callback-led; no competition, more friction.
Standard Bank	Name + SA ID (no calc)	Explicit, standalone consent ✓	Yes (single-bank)	Best consent UX; worst opening (ID first, no hook).
Nedbank	"Ask us to call you back"	Step 2, post-application	Yes (single-bank) · covers costs for "qualifying" clients	Most passive CTA in market.
ABSA	"Switch now" → application	In portal	"Great Escape" promo (single-bank)	Strongest incentive, buried; no self-qualify calculator.

WHITE SPACE

What only Bondly does

- **Savings-first hero before any contact capture** — every bank and most originators ask for a form or full registration first.
- **Multi-bank competition for a switch** — the banks' own pages only switch you *to them*; SA Home Loans is single-lender.
- **Two (soon three) decision framings** — lower monthly / finish sooner / cash-out — as a narrative choice, not buried calculator outputs.
- **A graceful "your rate is fine" path** — competitors dead-end the competitively-priced homeowner; Bondly captures them.

WHERE SA IS STRONGER

- **SA Home Loans**: documented 10-step roadmap + **Quick Cash bridging** (R75k in 72h) to cover switching costs upfront — a gap no originator fills.
- **Standard Bank**: explicit, legible credit-consent language.
- **ABSA / FNB**: named, time-boxed cost-coverage incentives that create urgency.

The remortgage winners agree on a pattern. Adopt it.

Across the UK, Australia and the US, the services that actually convert switchers — despite inertia — converge on the same spine Bondly already has. The lessons below are adapted for SA (no mature open banking; prime-linked variable rates; switching = full re-registration).

SERVICE	REGION	THE SINGLE SMARTEST MECHANIC	THE ADAPTED LESSON FOR BONDLY
Athena	AU	"Quote in <5 min, no credit checks yet — we only need your property + current loan." AcceleRATES auto-drops the rate as LVR falls.	Your no-credit-check savings-first opening is literally Athena's. Borrow their <i>LTV-milestone</i> logic for nurture triggers.
Habito	UK	Calculator → a few questions → a human expert does <i>all</i> the admin + chasing; tracked in a dashboard.	Name the admin you absorb. The dashboard = your pipeline tracker. Keep the human in the anxiety moments.
Mojo	UK	Shows existing-lender rate <i>side-by-side</i> with open-market; found £50/mo is the switch tipping point ; "Rate Check Promise."	Find SA's rand tipping point and make it unmissable. Offer a "we'll re-check if rates drop before completion" promise.
Sprive	UK	Open banking auto-discovers the mortgage; ERC-adjusted <i>daily</i> trigger tells you when switching pays.	The data-light version: your rate-watch engine computes "is it worth it yet?" continuously and pings on yes.
Tembo / L&C	UK	No-credit-check eligibility across 100+ lenders; rate-drop guarantee inside a 6-month lock.	Eligibility confidence (bankability) before commitment is the conversion lever — earn it with a soft signal.
Joust	AU	Anonymous reverse auction — lenders <i>bid</i> for the borrower; reverses the power dynamic.	"Banks compete for your bond" — fits your commission-from-bank model. Use it <i>only</i> where the signal supports it.
Better.com	US	Conversational AI ("Betsy") → personalised pre-approval in <3 min; soft pull happens invisibly in-chat.	Conversational framing lowers perceived friction at each step; a future-state for Bondly's qualify ladder.
Lendi	AU	"Rate Radar" detects the trigger and an agentic-AI intake starts the refinance — morning alert → evening lodged.	The endgame for your nurture list: trigger-detected, AI-assisted re-engagement, human for the close.

The universal inertia-killer isn't a lower rate — it's "we make the paperwork disappear."

Habito ("we do the badgering"), Athena (handles discharge from the old lender), L&C ("we handle all the paperwork"). In SA the admin is heavier (two attorneys, 90-day notice, deeds office) — so naming and absorbing it is an even bigger lever.

Where AI is not the answer: the trust to hand over your SA ID and R1.5m bond. That is won with human reassurance, POPIA framing, bank logos and honest cost disclosure — not a chatbot. Pure-AI broking has under-performed everywhere; hybrid human+AI is the converting model.

Why this ordering, and not another.

The principles doing the work

- **Value before friction.** Show the savings range + Switch Score *before* any personal ask. Never gate the Verdict — the result is the reason they continue.
- **Field count drives abandonment, not steps.** Multi-step beats single-page (~86% higher completion in lead-gen); 27% abandon a form that merely *looks* long. Split the asks; show progress.
- **Endowed progress.** A bar that starts at "Step 1 complete" (because the calculator was real work) lifts completion vs one starting at zero.
- **Loss aversion.** "You're paying R1,850 *more* every month" beats "you could save R1,850" — losses motivate ~2×.
- **Phone is the highest-friction field.** ~70% are reluctant; making it optional has doubled completion. Email first, phone optional & late.
- **Ranges beat false precision.** "R1,600–R2,100/mo" reads as honest; "R1,847" reads as invented. Keep the range; explain its basis.
- **Anxiety is per-field.** Put reassurance *next to* the scary field (ID, income), not in a generic top banner. ID gets its own screen.

Recommended capture moment

Capture **email the instant the Verdict lands** — intent is at its peak and email is the lowest-anxiety ask. Defer phone (optional) and ID (gated behind apply-intent) to the committed end of the ladder, where sunk-cost makes them small asks. This is the difference between "more leads, lower quality" (capture early) and "fewer, bank-ready leads" (capture value-first) — and for a commission-on-completion model, quality wins.

Already doing well — protect these

- Verdict before contact capture ✓
- "Reading" animation primes credibility ✓
- Savings as a *range* ✓
- "Lower payment vs finish sooner" choice ✓
- Optional (not mandatory) statement upload ✓
- Staged capture via correlationId ✓

The tension to manage — frictionless vs bank-ready

The whole ladder optimises for completion. But the only revenue event is a bank *accepting* and the bond *registering* — so a flood of unscreened leads burns the bank relationships that are the actual moat. Resolution: keep the ladder frictionless, but compute a **soft, non-pull bankability signal early** (LTV + affordability band + arrears self-declaration) so the "banks will compete" claim is earned and the leads you submit are genuinely bank-ready. If acceptance rates still lag, a light Experian-style soft check (MortgageMarket's model) becomes the next lever — added as an *optional accelerator*, never a gate.

The break-even math is the strategy.

Switching a bond in SA is a **full re-registration**, not a rate tweak. The cost hurdle is why "switch now" is a minority sport — and why the rate-watch list is the real volume business.

R30k–R40k

REALISTIC SWITCHING FRICTION ON A ~R1M BOND (REGISTRATION + CANCELLATION + INITIATION)

~20 mo

BREAK-EVEN ON A TYPICAL 0.75–1% CUT (R22K COST ÷ ~R1,100/MO SAVED)

8–10 yr

BREAK-EVEN ON A THIN 0.5% CUT ON A SMALL BOND — I.E. "DON'T SWITCH, WATCH"

Who should switch **now** (the value segment)

- Larger bonds (≈ R1.5m+) where a 0.5–1% cut is real money.
- Big rate gaps (1%+ above what they'd get today).
- **Low LTV / seasoned bonds** — banks compete hardest *and* cover the most cost (Absa up to R30k at the top tier).
- Long remaining horizon in the home (clears break-even comfortably).

SA's market is shifting to the >R3m band — exactly this segment. That's where to spend acquisition.

Who should **watch** (the volume segment)

- Sub-R1.5m bonds with a modest rate gap — break-even too long today.
- High-LTV or recently-originated bonds.
- Anyone where the honest net-of-cost number says "not yet."

The reframe: these aren't lost leads — they're the compounding asset. A prime cut or a few years of paydown flips them to "switch now," and Bondly is the brand that told them honestly and kept watch.

Bank cost-coverage matrix — the lever that shortens break-even (surface it on the Verdict)

BANK	WHAT THEY COVER FOR SWITCHERS	THE CATCH (STATE IT HONESTLY)
ABSA "Great Escape"	Tiered: R500k–2.5m → up to R10k ; R2.5–4.5m → R20k ; R4.5m+ → R30k ; +50% off registration; +up to R6k cancellation.	Coverage is thinnest exactly where the median bond sits; the R20k+R6k needs an Absa cheque account + debit order. Valid to 31 Aug 2026.
FNB	Pays cancellation + attorney registration costs; R6,100 initiation back in eBucks.	Registration coverage conditional on grant ≈ ≥R600k; <i>excludes</i> the old bank's early-termination penalty; eBucks ≠ cash.
Nedbank	Covers switching costs for "qualifying" clients.	Not surfaced as an instant qualifier; eligibility opaque.
SA Home Loans / Capitec	"Quick Cash" bridging — R75k in 72h + R150k on signing — to fund costs upfront.	Single-lender; you're switching <i>to</i> them.

Build this as an **admin-updatable promotions field**, not hardcoded copy — bank incentives change. Naming the right incentive for the right bond size is a concrete, on-your-side differentiator no calculator offers today.

It's not FAIS. Know the real rules.

Home loans are **NCA** credit agreements, not FAIS "financial products" — so a savings comparison/Switch Score needs *no FSP licence* (FAIS only bites if you bundle insurance). Bondly is an intermediary, not a credit provider, so **no NCR registration is required**. The binding constraints are CPA (honesty), POPIA (consent), and the bank's own duties. *Practitioner checklist — get formal legal sign-off before launch.*

STAGE	COLLECT	LAWFUL BASIS / CONSENT	THE RULE TO HONOUR
Calculator	Balance, rate (no personal data)	None yet	Frame the Switch Score as <i>indicative, not advice</i> (CPA s.41 — no "you will save / you qualify" as fact).
Rate-watch opt-in	Email (for alerts)	POPIA s.69 explicit opt-in — un-pre-ticked, Form-4 style, with one-click opt-out	Electronic direct marketing needs prior consent. The IR issued its first enforcement notice (Feb '24) for exactly this.
Email capture	Email	s.11 necessity + s.18 just-in-time notice	State who Bondly is, why, and that data will be shared with banks if they proceed.
Light qualify	Income band, employment	s.11 necessity	NCA affordability (s.81) is the <i>bank's</i> job — don't present this as a credit decision.
Formal details	Name, SA ID , income, address	s.11 necessity — ID <i>only</i> at apply-intent	SA ID is ordinary PI (not "special" under s.26) but high fraud value — data-minimisation = collect late.
Submit	Full package → named banks	Named-bank sharing consent (explicit)	Sharing with multiple lenders must be a disclosed, named purpose — not buried in T&Cs.

MUST DO

- Separate **marketing consent** (rate alerts) from service consent — standalone, un-pre-ticked.
- Just-in-time **s.18 notices** at email, income, and ID stages.
- **Name the banks** before submission; get explicit acknowledgement.
- Show **break-even + costs** next to savings (CPA s.41 honesty).
- Non-advice disclaimer on the Switch Score.

MUST NOT

- Run **any** credit-bureau enquiry (even "soft") without NCA-compliant consent — keep "no credit check" operationally true.
- Collect the **SA ID** before apply-intent.
- Assert a **guaranteed rate/approval** or "3+ banks will compete" without a signal (CPA s.41).
- Share data with banks before explicit confirmation.
- Use the rate-alert consent to send *general* marketing.

FICA KYC is the bank's obligation (it is the Accountable Institution), not Bondly's — but handle any ID/address you do collect securely under POPIA. Get a FAIS opinion only if you ever attach insurance to the flow.

Out-execute with AI; prove it with the funnel.

AI for intelligence

- Weekly LLM digest of competitor switch pages, bank incentives, and ad creative — "what changed & why it matters."
- Cluster SA switching reviews/Reddit complaints into unmet-need themes → differentiation copy.
- Auto-watch bank cost-coverage promos → feed the admin-updatable promotions field.

AI for go-to-market

- Programmatic SEO: "[bank] home loan switch costs," "is it worth switching my bond," city/bank-size pages — honest, calculator-backed.
- "[Competitor] alternative" + "switch from [bank]" comparison pages capturing branded switch demand.
- The rate-watch engine itself: AI computes per-user "is it worth it yet?" and personalises the re-engagement.

AI in the product

- Statement OCR → instant balance/rate/affordability pre-fill (with an operator agreement, POPIA s.21).
- Conversational qualify ladder (Better.com's "Betsy" model) to cut perceived friction.
- Soft bankability scoring from non-pull signals to lift bank-acceptance rates.

Instrument the funnel — the metrics the draft was missing

METRIC	WHY IT'S THE ONE THAT MATTERS	FIRST A/B TEST TO RUN
Accept → register rate	The only revenue event. Everything upstream is vanity until this is tracked.	Soft bankability signal on vs off — does it lift bank acceptance?
Verdict → email CVR	Tests value-first capture & the Verdict upgrades.	Net-of-cost Verdict vs gross-savings-only.
Email → formal-app CVR	Health of the data ladder.	ID-late + split screens vs single formal-details screen.
App → bank-accept rate	Lead quality / relationship health.	With vs without early soft signal.
Rate-watch opt-in rate	Size of the compounding asset.	"We'll tell you when it pays" framing vs generic newsletter.
Abandonment-recovery rate	Recovers SA mobile/connectivity drop-offs.	Recovery email on vs off (from the step-3 email).
Claimed-vs-realised savings	Trust integrity & CPA exposure.	Range width calibration vs realised offers.

Before any of this: confirm the switch unit-economics.

Originators *are* paid by the bank on switches/refinances (verified) — but the exact bank→originator commission % on a switch, and the clawback on early cancellation/settlement, are not public. That number decides how hard to push the funnel vs the nurture list. It's a conversation with your bank partners, and it's move #0.

What the red-team caught — and what we did about it.

After the first research round, a dedicated scrutiny agent attacked the draft. It surfaced three load-bearing weaknesses; a second research round answered each. The recommendation you've just read is the *post-scrutiny* version. Here is the audit trail.

#	BLINDSPOT RAISED	SEVERITY	ROUND-2 FINDING	HOW THE REC CHANGED
1	Break-even quietly kills the median bond → "qualified lead" inventory is thin	● CRITICAL	Confirmed: ~R30–40k friction vs ~R300/mo on a small cut = 8–10yr break-even.	Core reframe: product = switch-readiness <i>engine</i> ; nurture list is co-equal, not a footnote.
2	The compliance frame is wrong — it's NCA/CPA, not FAIS	● HIGH	Confirmed: home loans sit outside FAIS; originators need no NCR registration; CPA s.41 + POPIA bind.	Compliance section re-anchored on NCA-CPA-POPIA-FICA; FAIS only if insurance is bundled.
3	MortgageMarket is a <i>present</i> threat, not "emerging"	● CRITICAL	Confirmed: direct bank contracts announced May/Jun '26 + 2-min Experian pre-qual.	White space downgraded from "moat" to "6–12 month window"; build the compounding asset fast.
4	"No credit check" is sold as pure CX win — it's a lead-quality liability	● HIGH	Only an accept-and-register pays; junk leads burn bank relationships (the moat).	Added the soft non-pull bankability signal; "no <i>hard</i> check" preserved.
5	"3+ banks compete" with no signal = CPA s.41 contradiction	● HIGH	You can't assert bank appetite with no data.	Claim now <i>calibrated</i> to the soft signal; vague where the signal is thin.
6	Absa "R26k flat" is wrong — coverage is tiered	● MED	Tiered R10k / R20k / R30k by loan size; thinnest at the median.	Corrected throughout; cost-coverage now a per-tier matrix (p.8).
7	Whole personas the flow silently fails	● MED	High-LTV, recent-bond, self-employed, fixed-rate, access-bond each get false hope.	Added honest persona-branching table (p.4).
8	No metrics / no measurement plan	● MED	Without accept→register tracking, nothing is provable.	Added the funnel-instrumentation + A/B table (p.10).

Still open — verify before build

- **Switch commission % + clawback** (bank→originator) — the gating unit-economics number.
- **Bank appetite for multi-bank *switch* submissions** vs purchase origination — confirm parity with each partner.
- Exact reject-rate threshold that strains a bank relationship.
- SA fixed-rate & self-employed homeowner prevalence (to size the persona exclusions).

VERDICT ON THE VERDICT

The five sharpening moves and the savings-first / progressive-ladder / human-follow-up spine are **sound**. The draft was overconfident on inventory, regulatory frame, and defensibility — all now corrected. Net: **don't rebuild the flow; do ship the net-of-cost Verdict + compliant nurture first, and treat the white space as a window to exploit fast.**

How this was built; what to trust.

Four parallel research lanes (SA originators · international switching · CX/behavioural · SA regulatory), independently verified, then attacked by a blindspot scrutiny agent, then a second targeted research round. Public sources only. Inferences are flagged; a confident wrong number is worse than an honest "unknown."

HIGH CONFIDENCE

SA switching mechanics & costs; bank cost-coverage (Absa tiers, FNB); POPIA s.18/s.69; NCA/FAIS applicability & no-NCR-registration; competitor flow structures; CX field-count/phone/loss-aversion evidence; international mechanics.

MEDIUM

Exact registration/cancellation rand figures (vary by bond size & attorney); some competitors' field sequences behind registration walls; the precise rand "switch tipping point" for SA.

UNKNOWN — GO GET IT

Bank→originator commission % on a switch + clawback terms; per-bank appetite for multi-bank switch submissions; SA fixed-rate & thin-file prevalence. All require partner/bank confirmation.

Key sources

SA switching costs/mechanics: property24.com (is switching worthwhile); rateweb.co.za (refinance break-even); meridianfinance.co.za (2025 switch trend); capetownlawyer.co.za (bond attorney fees 2025).

SA originators: ooba.co.za (Bond Indicator, refinance, oobarometer Q1/Q3 '26); betterbond.co.za (affordability, pre-approval, refinancing excl.); mortgagemarket.co.za + app + techfinancials.co.za (direct bank contracts, May '26); mortgages.easyequities.co.za.

SA bank switch journeys: sahomeloans.com (switch calc, 10-step); capitechomeloans.co.za (Quick Cash); standardbank.co.za (switch, consent); personal.nedbank.co.za (switch); absa.co.za (Great Escape, move-your-home-loan); fnb.co.za (switch my home loan); investec.com.

International switching: athena.com.au (refi, AcceleRATES); habito.com (remortgage); mojomortgages.com (rate-check, product-transfer); sprive.com; tembomoney.com; landc.co.uk; joust.com.au; better.com; rocketmortgage.com; AWS/Lendi agentic-AI case study.

CX & behavioural: Baymard Institute (form UX benchmark); Nielsen Norman Group (single-column, mobile forms); Nunes & Drèze 2006 (endowed progress); Kahneman & Tversky 1979 (loss aversion); vitaldesign/logit (phone-field case studies); outgrow (interactive calculators).

SA regulatory: banking.org.za (NCA, FAIS); popia.co.za (s.11/18/26/69); michalsons.com + cliffedekkerhofmeyr.com (IR direct-marketing guidance + first enforcement notice); ooba.co.za (how to become a bond originator — no NCR registration); youverify.co (FICA KYC); ooba.co.za (fixed vs variable).

One-line close. Bondly already has the best switching opening in South Africa. Make it *honest* (net-of-cost Verdict), make it *compounding* (compliant rate-watch), and make it *fast* (the window is open now, not forever) — and the switch becomes Bondly's category to lose. *This document is competitive intelligence and practitioner guidance, not legal advice; obtain formal SA financial-services legal sign-off before launch.*